

Session 4: Racialized Experiences in STEM

Pework and Session Agenda

In this session, we will focus on understanding what being in STEM is like for Black, Indigenous, and other people of color (BIPOC). We will begin by reading an article that reframes the leaky pipeline as an unequal obstacle course, then listen to Dr. Ebony McGee discussing her personal experiences with racism in STEM. Our discussion will center on understanding racism and other forms of marginalization as systemic issues rather than interpersonal ones.

Pework

Objective: Introduce participants to the concept of racism in STEM and how those experiences take form.

- **Activities:**
 - **Article:** [Nature Geoscience](#) - Scientists from Historically Excluded Groups Face a Hostile Obstacle Course
 - **Podcast:** [The Pitt Pulse Podcast Episode 1](#) - Introduction to Racism in STEM with Dr. Ebony McGee (31 min)
- **Reflection 1:** Did the materials bring up any racialized experiences you have witnessed or lived? If so, how did this experience feel?
- **Reflection 2:** In the podcast episode, Dr. McGee states that mentoring programs “cannot dismantle 400 years of structural racism in society.” With that in mind, consider the following questions:
 - Is the work we are doing in this mentor training transformative?
 - If not, what purpose does it serve? What issues doesn't it solve?
 - What does being a culturally aware mentor do for mentees in your sphere of influence?
 - **Submission:** Be ready to share your questions and reflections during the live session.

Agenda

- 0 - 5 min – Welcome, ice breaker in chat
- 5 - 10 min – Anonymous Writing Prompt: *Did the pre-work bring up any racialized experiences you have witnessed or lived? How did this experience feel?*
- 10 - 25 min – Group discussion of selected experiences
- 25 - 30 min – BREAK
- 30 - 55 min – Full group discussion re: the utility of mentoring in the context of larger systemic issues in academia
- 55 - 60 min – BREAK
- 60 - 85 min – Full group discussion re: moving forward to address both systemic and individual issues
- 85 - 90 min – Wrap up